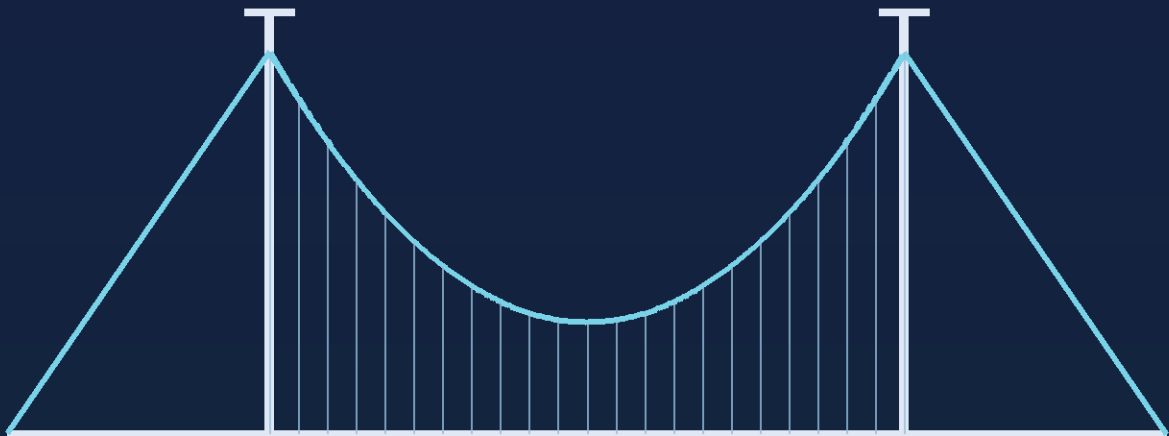


USER GUIDE

SimBridge

User Guide

Simulator files in the Finder — grant, mount,
work in the Finder. In minutes.



devForPeople

Andreas Maser · Juli 2026

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What SimBridge does

SimBridge mounts the file storage of your **iOS Simulator apps** as a regular location in the **macOS Finder**. Instead of digging through cryptic paths like `~/Library/Developer/CoreSimulator/Devices/<UUID>/...`, you open, edit, copy, rename, and delete the files right in the Finder — and changes appear live while SimBridge is running.

This guide walks you through everything that matters in a few minutes: granting access, mounting a location, working in the Finder, cleaning up — plus the limits and the most common snags.

Requirements

- **macOS 14** (Sonoma) or later.
- **Xcode** with the Simulators you want to look into.
- SimBridge is installed and lives in **/Applications** (launch it from there — not from your Downloads folder).

Ready in one minute

1. Open SimBridge.
2. On first launch, **grant Simulator access** (one time — see the next section).
3. Pick a Simulator on the left, click **Mount** next to a source on the right.
4. The location appears in the **Finder** under *Locations* — done.

The rest of this guide explains each step in more detail.

Step 1 — Grant Simulator access (one time)

How to: 1. Click **Grant Simulator Access...** (or the folder button in the toolbar). 2. In the dialog, click the “**Devices**” folder inside **CoreSimulator** once. 3. Click **Grant Access**.

The sidebar now shows your Simulators. You only do this once.

Don’t see any Simulators? Start a Simulator in Xcode, install/open your app there, and click **Refresh** in SimBridge.

Step 2 — Mount a location

Pick a Simulator on the left. On the right you’ll see up to three **source types** — depending on where the files you’re after actually live:

- **App data** — your app’s container: Documents, Library, tmp. Most of what your app saves itself ends up here.
- **App Group** — the app’s shared storage, e.g. a **SwiftData database** (default.s tore) or files shared between the app and its extensions.
- **On My iPhone** — the local “On My iPhone” storage that the iOS Files app shows.

How to: 1. Select a Simulator on the left. 2. Click **Mount** next to the source you want. 3. The location appears in the Finder under *Locations* and in SimBridge under **Mounted**.

A tip if you’re hunting for a file and can’t find it: what the iOS Files app shows under “On My iPhone” often is **not** in the app’s Documents, but in the local storage or the App Group. When in doubt, try all three source types.

Step 3 — Work in the Finder

A mounted location behaves like any other Finder folder. You can:

- **open and view** files and folders,
- **edit** contents (changes go straight into the Simulator),
- **create** new files and folders,
- **rename, move, and delete,**
- drag & drop files **in and out**.

This lets you, for example, quickly drop a prepared test file into the app container, copy out a SwiftData database for inspection, or delete a broken preferences file.

Live updates

Files your **running app** creates or changes appear in the Finder automatically — **as long as SimBridge stays open**. You don’t need to refresh; the location keeps itself up to date.

Deeply nested changes refresh as soon as you (re)open the folder in question in the Finder.

Working from the menu bar

SimBridge lives in the **menu bar**. You can close the main window — the app keeps running so live updates don’t stop. From the menu-bar item you can reopen the main

window anytime and see at a glance what's currently mounted.

Show only running Simulators

If you've created many Simulators, the list gets long. The **Only running** toggle in the toolbar hides all stopped Simulators and shows just the one you're working with.

Removing locations & cleaning up

Take a single location back out of the Finder with **Remove** (the files inside the Simulator stay untouched of course — only the Finder location is unregistered).

The “...” menu at the top right has two cleanup actions:

- **Remove Unavailable Locations** — clears locations whose Simulator or app no longer exists (e.g. because you deleted the Simulator). Such locations are dimmed and marked with a warning icon in the list.
- **Remove All Finder Locations...** — unregisters every SimBridge location at once. Handy if something ever gets stuck. You can always mount again afterwards.

What SimBridge does not do — the limits

- **Simulators only, no real devices.** The files of a physical iPhone can't be surfaced the same way, technically. For devices, keep using Xcode or `xcrun devicectl` in the Terminal.
- **Not a Mac App Store app.** SimBridge reaches into Xcode's CoreSimulator folder — which is incompatible with App Store rules. That's why it's distributed outside the store (signed and notarized) so macOS trusts it.

When something gets stuck

No Simulators or apps shown. Start a Simulator in Xcode, install/open your app there, and click **Refresh** in SimBridge. Also check that access is granted (Step 1).

The location appears, but nothing loads. Enable the location in the **Finder** — depending on your macOS version you may need to switch it on once in the Finder sidebar or Finder settings. It then shows its contents.

A location is dimmed (“Unavailable”). Its Simulator or app no longer exists. Get rid of it via “...” → **Remove Unavailable Locations**.

A location is stuck and won't remove. Use “...” → **Remove All Finder Locations...** and mount again afterwards.

Symbols at a glance

- **Bolt** — the *Only running* toggle: shows only started Simulators.
- **Folder with gear** — grant or change Simulator access.
- **Circular arrow** — Refresh: rescan Simulators and locations.
- **Blue app tile** — App data (Documents/Library/tmp).
- **Purple box tile** — App Group (e.g. a SwiftData database).

- **Teal drive tile** — On My iPhone (local storage).
- **Green dot** — the Simulator is currently running.

You'll find the same legend anytime inside the app under **Help** (⌘?).

In short

Grant access once, mount a source, work in the Finder — that's all there is to it. Sim-Bridge turns tedious path-digging into a double-click in the sidebar. Happy building.